

# Executive AI Briefing

Plain-spoken AI orientation for leaders who need clarity before making budget, policy, vendor, or training decisions.

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|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Format</b>   | One focused Zoom briefing, optionally followed by a Q&A; or planning session.                              |
| <b>Level</b>    | Leadership level: clarity before technology decisions                                                      |
| <b>Audience</b> | Executives, founders, board-adjacent leaders, and department heads who need a useful map rather than hype. |

## Learner outcomes

- Separate AI training needs from software purchasing needs.
- Ask better questions about vendors, data, policy, implementation, and organizational readiness.
- Identify decisions that need more learning before investment.
- Leave with a leadership vocabulary for opportunity, uncertainty, human review, and responsible experimentation.

## Guiding questions

- What should leaders understand before authorizing tools, pilots, policies, or budgets?
- Where does education need to come before procurement?
- Which risks require the right internal owners rather than a training promise?
- What small next step would increase clarity without locking the organization into a premature decision?

## Readiness checks

- Leaders can explain why fluency training may be needed before tool investment.
- Leaders can ask practical questions about data boundaries, review, ownership, and expected value.
- The organization has named which decisions require internal policy, legal, privacy, or technical owners.
- The next step is small enough to learn from and clear enough to communicate.

## Curriculum modules

### What leaders need to know now

A clear map of current AI capabilities, limitations, tool categories, and common misconceptions.

### Clarity before complexity

We distinguish fluency, workflow practice, policy, vendor evaluation, and implementation work.

### Responsible decision questions

Leaders practice asking about data exposure, review requirements, accountability, and expected business value.

### Next-step decision paths

The briefing ends with a recommendation for training, discovery, a small pilot, or a deliberate wait.

### Internal communication

Leaders practice explaining AI next steps in language that reduces confusion, fear, and unrealistic expectations.

## Session flow

### Landscape

Explain current AI capabilities, limitations, and tool categories in plain language.

### Separate

Distinguish fluency training, workflow practice, policy, vendor evaluation, implementation, and governance.

### Question

Work through leader-level questions about value, data exposure, review burden, and accountability.

### Decide

Sort likely next steps into train, discover, pilot, wait, or seek specialist advice.

### Communicate

Draft a short internal message that frames AI learning without hype or guarantees.

## Practice labs

### Vendor question drill

Translate broad vendor claims into concrete questions about data handling, review, workflow fit, and training needs.

### Decision-gate scenario

Walk through an AI idea and decide whether it belongs in training, discovery, pilot, procurement, or wait.

### **Risk language rehearsal**

Practice naming uncertainty and boundaries without implying legal, medical, compliance, or cybersecurity guarantees.

### **Leadership message draft**

Create a calm message that explains why the organization is learning before buying or implementing.

## **Tangible cases**

### **Vendor pitch review**

**Situation:** A CEO hears a vendor promise broad productivity gains and wants better questions before spending money.

**Learner task:** Translate the pitch into concrete questions about workflow fit, data handling, review, ownership, and training.

**Starter prompt:** Turn this vendor claim into practical evaluation questions. Cover workflow fit, data handling, human review, implementation burden, training needs, lock-in, and evidence we should request: [vendor claim].

### **Board-level AI stance**

**Situation:** A board or senior leadership group asks whether the organization has an AI strategy.

**Learner task:** Draft a calm response that frames learning, boundaries, and next steps without overpromising outcomes.

**Starter prompt:** Draft a board-level AI learning statement. Emphasize clarity before complexity, staff fluency, safe experimentation, human judgment, and decisions that need the right internal owners. Avoid hype and guarantees.

### **Policy before practice tension**

**Situation:** A department wants to ban, buy, or standardize AI before staff understand practical use.

**Learner task:** Separate what training can solve from what requires policy, legal, privacy, technical, or procurement decisions.

**Starter prompt:** Given this leadership concern, separate issues into fluency training, workflow practice, policy, procurement, technical implementation, and specialist review. Recommend a small next step for each: [concern].

## **Prompt library**

### **Decision gate**

Evaluate this AI idea through decision gates: learn, practice, pilot, buy, wait, or seek specialist review. Explain the evidence needed before moving to the next gate: [AI idea].

### **Leadership briefing prep**

Prepare a plain-language executive briefing on [AI topic]. Include what it is, what it is useful for, limits, risks, good questions to ask, and a cautious next step.

### **Vendor question bank**

Create a vendor question bank for [tool category]. Include questions about data use, privacy, review workflows, admin controls, implementation effort, training, support, and exit options.

### **Internal message**

Draft an internal message explaining that we are learning about AI before making major technology decisions. Keep it calm, practical, nontechnical, and clear about responsible use boundaries.

## **Materials to develop**

- Executive briefing deck outline
- Vendor question guide
- AI investment readiness checklist
- Train, pilot, buy, or wait worksheet
- Leadership communication template
- Decision-gate question bank

## **Diagram candidates**

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Decision gates for AI investment
- Build, buy, train, or wait decision tree
- Leadership clarity map: learn, test, decide, communicate

## **Follow-up work**

- Select a first audience for training or discovery.
- List vendor, policy, or data questions that require specialist review.
- Schedule a follow-up briefing or readiness sprint if the organization needs a fuller map.

## Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

## API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.